

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	18 — The State, the Government, and You
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: the government is only ONE of the state's four parts (population, territory, government, sovereignty) and changes with elections while the state endures; the majority CANNOT do whatever it wants (rights and the rule of law protect minorities); NOT all democracies are republics (the UK has a monarch); the police and army are STATE machinery the government directs, not the government itself; and the executive has TWO parts - the political executive (ministers) and the permanent executive (bureaucracy). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A 'state' (or nation) is best described as:

- (A) only the buildings where ministers work
- (B) a political organisation with authority to govern a defined territory and population
- (C) the same thing as the current government
- (D) a single elected leader

2. The four parts of a state are:

- (A) legislature, executive, judiciary and police
- (B) union, state, local and village
- (C) protector, provider, regulator and voter
- (D) population, territory, government and sovereignty

3. Within a state, the government is:

- (A) the whole state by itself
- (B) only one of the four parts
- (C) the same as the population
- (D) the same as the territory

4. The claim 'the government and the state are the same thing' is wrong because:

- (A) there is no government in a state
- (B) the state changes at every election but the government never does

(C) the state is only the police

(D) governments change after elections, but the state (people, territory, sovereignty) remains

5. The chapter's analogy 'teachers change while the school stays' compares the school to the:

(A) government, and the teachers to the state

(B) territory, and the teachers to the population

(C) sovereignty, and the teachers to the police

(D) state, and the teachers to the government

6. A 'government' is the group or system that runs the country by:

(A) making, enforcing and resolving disputes about laws

(B) owning all the land in the territory (C) choosing the population's religion

(D) replacing the Constitution each year

7. Unlike the state, a government:

(A) never changes at all

(B) has no role in running the country

(C) changes after elections

(D) is the same as the territory

8. When a new party wins an election, what changes and what stays?

(A) the state changes, but the government continues

(B) both vanish completely

(C) neither changes ever

(D) the government changes, but the state continues

9. Making, enforcing and interpreting laws are the work of the:

(A) population alone

(B) territory itself

(C) sovereignty by itself

(D) government, through its three organs

10. The government runs the state, but the state is bigger because it also includes:

(A) only the ministers

(B) the people, the land, and sovereignty

(C) only the courts

(D) nothing beyond the government

11. 'Sovereignty' is:

(A) the power of one minister to ignore the law

(B) the full power of a state to make and enforce its own laws without outside control

(C) the right to vote in elections

(D) the land a state governs

12. A state with full sovereignty:

(A) is not controlled by any outside power in making its laws

(B) must obey a foreign government's orders (C) has no laws of its own

(D) cannot enforce any law

13. The claim 'the police and the army ARE the government' is wrong because they are:

- (A) the entire government by themselves
- (B) the same as the population
- (C) part of the state's machinery that the government directs
- (D) an outside foreign power

14. After an election changes the government, the police and the armed forces:

- (A) are all dismissed and replaced
- (B) become the new government
- (C) continue serving the state
- (D) stop existing

15. The police and army differ from the elected government in that they:

- (A) are permanent parts of the state, not a team elected for a fixed term
- (B) are elected every five years
- (C) change with every new party
- (D) make the country's laws

16. India is described as a:

- (A) hereditary monarchy
- (B) democratic republic
- (C) theocracy
- (D) one-party dictatorship

17. A 'democracy' is a system of:

- (A) rule by a hereditary king
- (B) rule by religious leaders
- (C) rule by a single unelected officer
- (D) rule by the people, who choose their government through free and fair elections

18. A 'republic' is a form of government in which:

- (A) the head of state inherits the throne
- (B) there is no constitution at all
- (C) the head of state is elected (not hereditary) and rulers' powers are limited by a constitution
- (D) the people never vote

19. The claim 'all democracies are republics' is wrong because:

- (A) no democracy is ever a republic
- (B) countries like the UK, Canada and Sweden are democracies but keep monarchs, so they are not republics
- (C) only republics can be democracies
- (D) every monarchy is a republic

20. The UK, with an elected parliament but a hereditary monarch, is:

- (A) a democracy but not a republic
- (B) a republic but not a democracy
- (C) both a democracy and a republic
- (D) neither a democracy nor anything else

21. The key difference between 'democracy' and 'republic' is that democracy concerns _____ while republic concerns _____.

- (A) who rules (the people) ... whether the head of state is elected, not hereditary
- (B) whether the head of state is elected ... who rules
- (C) the size of the army ... the size of the population
- (D) the territory ... the sovereignty

- 22.** The Constitution guarantees everyone's fundamental rights so that:
- (A) the majority can do whatever it likes
 - (B) the majority cannot trample a minority's rights
 - (C) only the majority has rights
 - (D) only the government has rights
- 23.** The claim 'in a democracy the majority can do whatever it wants' is wrong because:
- (A) the rule of law and guaranteed rights protect minorities from the majority
 - (B) the majority has no power at all
 - (C) minorities rule over the majority
 - (D) there are no rights in a democracy
- 24.** Protecting minority rights against the 'dominance of the majority' shows that, in India, the:
- (A) majority's wishes always override the law
 - (B) minorities have no protection
 - (C) rule of law is stronger than the mere wishes of the majority
 - (D) Constitution can be freely ignored
- 25.** The 'rule of law' is the principle that:
- (A) everyone, including the government, must follow the law
 - (B) the government is above all law
 - (C) only ordinary citizens must obey laws
 - (D) laws apply only to minorities
- 26.** 'Matsya nyaya', the 'law of the fishes', is the idea that:
- (A) fish make the best laws
 - (B) the weak always rule the strong
 - (C) without law and order, the powerful prey on the weak
 - (D) everyone is automatically equal without any law
- 27.** Why do we need a government, according to the rule-of-law idea?
- (A) so the strongest can rule without limits
 - (B) to remove all laws
 - (C) so no one ever has to follow rules
 - (D) to maintain order so the powerful cannot simply prey on the weak
- 28.** A society with no law or order would slide toward:
- (A) perfect equality with no effort
 - (B) the rule of law
 - (C) matsya nyaya, where the strong dominate the weak
 - (D) a guaranteed constitution
- 29.** The rule of law is the opposite of matsya nyaya because it:
- (A) protects the weak by binding even the powerful to the law
 - (B) lets the powerful ignore the law
 - (C) applies only to the weak
 - (D) abolishes all government
- 30.** The 'legislature' is the organ of government that:
- (A) carries out and enforces the laws
 - (B) makes the laws
 - (C) interprets the laws and settles disputes
 - (D) commands the army

- 31.** The word 'legislature' comes from Latin roots meaning:
(A) 'to carry out' (B) 'judge' or 'to say the law'
(C) 'law' and 'a bringing or proposing' (D) 'treaty or league'
- 32.** A body of elected representatives debating and passing a new law is acting as the:
(A) executive (B) judiciary
(C) bureaucracy (D) legislature
- 33.** The 'executive' is the organ that:
(A) makes the laws (B) interprets the laws and settles disputes
(C) elects the legislature (D) carries out and enforces the laws
- 34.** The executive has two parts: the political executive and the:
(A) hereditary executive (B) judicial executive
(C) permanent executive (the civil-service bureaucracy)
(D) legislative executive
- 35.** The 'political executive' (ministers):
(A) stays on whichever party wins (B) is selected by competitive exams
(C) sets the direction and changes with elections
(D) never changes at all
- 36.** The 'permanent executive' (bureaucracy):
(A) changes completely after every election
(B) stays on and implements decisions whichever party wins, giving steady administration
(C) makes the country's laws (D) is the head of state
- 37.** The claim 'only the ministers we elect run the country day to day' is wrong because:
(A) the permanent bureaucracy actually implements decisions whichever party wins
(B) ministers do everything entirely alone (C) there is no bureaucracy at all
(D) the courts run the daily administration
- 38.** 'Bureaucracy' refers to the:
(A) elected ministers who change with elections
(B) permanent, non-elected, exam-selected officers (civil servants) who run the government
(C) judges of the Supreme Court (D) voters in an election
- 39.** The 'judiciary' is the organ that:
(A) makes the laws (B) enforces the laws
(C) collects the taxes (D) interprets the laws and settles disputes
- 40.** The judiciary is called the 'watchdog' because it:

- (A) obeys every order of the ruling party
- (B) makes all the laws itself
- (C) independently checks that laws and actions follow the Constitution
- (D) commands the police

41. 'Judicial review' is the judiciary's power to:

- (A) write new laws for the country
- (B) elect the ministers
- (C) collect taxes
- (D) examine laws and government actions and strike down those that violate the Constitution

42. If the legislature passes a law that breaks the Constitution, the judiciary can:

- (A) strike it down through judicial review
- (B) do nothing about it
- (C) pass the law itself
- (D) arrest the voters

43. The judiciary's independence matters because it:

- (A) lets the ruling party control the courts
- (B) makes the courts obey ministers
- (C) removes all checks on power
- (D) lets the courts check even the government fairly

44. The government's 'triple role' is to act as:

- (A) legislature, executive and judiciary
- (B) union, state and local
- (C) protector, provider and regulator
- (D) population, territory and sovereignty

45. The government acting as 'protector' means it:

- (A) provides schools and hospitals
- (B) sets fair rules for businesses
- (C) collects citizens' votes
- (D) keeps citizens safe and defends the country

46. The government acting as 'provider' means it:

- (A) only defends the borders
- (B) supplies services like schools, hospitals and roads
- (C) only sets rules for markets
- (D) only counts votes

47. The government acting as 'regulator' means it:

- (A) only fights wars
- (B) sets and enforces fair rules for activities like business and trade
- (C) only builds hospitals
- (D) only holds elections

48. A government inspecting factories to ensure they follow safety rules is acting as a:

- (A) regulator
- (B) protector defending the borders
- (C) provider building roads
- (D) voter in an election

49. The 'Right to Information' (RTI) lets citizens:

- (A) ask the government for information about its actions, bringing transparency and accountability
- (B) vote twice in an election
- (C) ignore all government laws

(D) appoint the judges

50. Which is a way citizens hold the government accountable?

- (A) ignoring elections entirely
- (B) using RTI, the media, civil society and voting
- (C) leaving all decisions to one minister
- (D) abolishing the Constitution

51. By voting a poorly performing government out of office, citizens exercise:

- (A) sovereignty over a foreign state
- (B) accountability over the government
- (C) the role of regulator
- (D) judicial review

52. A free media that reports on government failures helps by:

- (A) making laws for the country
- (B) keeping the government accountable to citizens
- (C) replacing the courts
- (D) running the bureaucracy

53. 'Grievance redressal' systems let citizens:

- (A) vote in foreign elections
- (B) appoint ministers
- (C) strike down laws
- (D) complain about and seek fixes for problems with government services

54. India's three tiers of government are:

- (A) legislature, executive and judiciary
- (B) protector, provider and regulator
- (C) union, state and local
- (D) population, territory and sovereignty

55. 'Decentralisation' means:

- (A) concentrating all power in one place
- (B) abolishing local government
- (C) giving power to a foreign country
- (D) spreading out power so local matters are decided locally

56. Having union, state and local tiers reflects the idea of:

- (A) decentralisation - decisions made at the level closest to the matter
- (B) keeping all power in one central office
- (C) rule by a single person
- (D) abolishing the states

57. 'Federalism' is a system in which:

- (A) power is shared between a central government and state/local governments
- (B) one central government holds all power alone
- (C) there is no central government at all
- (D) a king holds all power

58. Deciding local road repairs through a local body rather than the union government is an example of:

- (A) concentrating power at the centre
- (B) abolishing the local tier
- (C) decentralisation in action
- (D) foreign control

59. Which statement correctly distinguishes the state from the government?

- (A) the government has four parts and the state is one of them
- (B) they are exactly the same thing
- (C) the state has four parts (population, territory, government, sovereignty) and endures, while the government is one part that changes with elections
- (D) the state changes every election while the government never does

60. A student says, 'The government is the same as the state, the majority can do anything, and every democracy is a republic.' The best correction is:

- (A) the government is only one part of the state, rights protect minorities from the majority, and some democracies (like the UK) are not republics
- (B) all three statements are correct
- (C) the government is the whole state, but minorities are protected
- (D) every democracy is a republic, though the government can change

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	A	31	C	41	D	51	B
2	D	12	A	22	B	32	D	42	A	52	B
3	B	13	C	23	A	33	D	43	D	53	D
4	D	14	C	24	C	34	C	44	C	54	C
5	D	15	A	25	A	35	C	45	D	55	D
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	B	46	B	56	A
7	C	17	D	27	D	37	A	47	B	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	B	48	A	58	C
9	D	19	B	29	A	39	D	49	A	59	C
10	B	20	A	30	B	40	C	50	B	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (B)** A state is a political organisation governing a defined territory and population, with four parts. It is not just buildings, the current government, or one leader.
- (D)** A state's four parts are population, territory, government and sovereignty. The others list organs, tiers, or government roles, not the parts of a state.
- (B)** The government is just one of the state's four parts. It is not the whole state, the population, or the territory.
- (D)** The government is one changing part; the state endures across elections - like teachers changing while the school stays. The reversal and 'state is only police' options are wrong.
- (D)** The lasting school is the state; the changing teachers are the government. The other pairings reverse or confuse the analogy.
- (A)** A government makes, enforces and interprets laws. It does not own all land, dictate religion, or rewrite the Constitution yearly.

- 7. (C)** Governments change after elections, while the state endures. A government does run the country and is not the territory.
- 8. (D)** An election changes the government while the state continues. The reversal and the 'both vanish / neither changes' options are wrong.
- 9. (D)** The government, through its legislature, executive and judiciary, makes, enforces and interprets laws. The population, territory and sovereignty are other parts of the state.
- 10. (B)** Besides the government, the state includes its population, territory and sovereignty. It is not only ministers, only courts, or just the government.
- 11. (B)** Sovereignty is a state's full power to make and enforce its own laws free of outside control. It is not a minister's whim, the vote, or the territory.
- 12. (A)** A sovereign state makes and enforces its own laws without outside control. It is not foreign-controlled, lawless, or unable to enforce law.
- 13. (C)** The police and army are part of the state's machinery directed by the government, not the government itself. They are not the whole government, the population, or foreign.
- 14. (C)** The police and armed forces continue serving the state across changes of government. They are not all dismissed, made the government, or ended.
- 15. (A)** The police and army are permanent state machinery, unlike the government elected for a fixed term. They are not elected, party-changing, or lawmakers.
- 16. (B)** India is a democratic republic. It is not a monarchy, theocracy, or dictatorship.
- 17. (D)** Democracy is rule by the people through free and fair elections. King-rule, religious rule and unelected-officer rule are other forms.
- 18. (C)** In a republic the head of state is elected, not hereditary, with powers limited by a constitution. Inheritance, no constitution, and no voting describe other systems.
- 19. (B)** The UK, Canada and Sweden are democracies with monarchs, so not republics - a democracy need not be a republic. The other options are false.
- 20. (A)** The UK is a democracy (elected parliament) but not a republic (it has a hereditary monarch). The other options misclassify it.
- 21. (A)** Democracy is about the people ruling; a republic is about an elected (non-hereditary) head of state. The first option captures this; the others reverse or confuse it.
- 22. (B)** Guaranteed rights mean the majority cannot trample minorities - the rule of law over mere numbers. It is not majority-can-do-anything, majority-only, or government-only rights.

- 23. (A)** The rule of law and constitutional rights protect minorities, so the majority cannot do anything it likes. The majority does have power, does not lose to minorities, and rights do exist.
- 24. (C)** Guaranteed rights make the rule of law stronger than the majority's wishes. The majority does not always override the law, minorities are protected, and the Constitution is not ignored.
- 25. (A)** The rule of law means everyone, even the government, must follow the law. It is not government-above-law, citizens-only, or minority-only.
- 26. (C)** Matsya nyaya ('law of the fishes') means that without law, the strong devour the weak - why we need a government. The other options are wrong.
- 27. (D)** Government and the rule of law maintain order, preventing matsya nyaya where the strong prey on the weak. It is not unlimited strong-rule, removing laws, or rule-free life.
- 28. (C)** Without law and order, society slides into matsya nyaya, the strong preying on the weak. It would not yield automatic equality, the rule of law, or a working constitution.
- 29. (A)** The rule of law binds even the powerful, protecting the weak - the opposite of matsya nyaya. It does not free the powerful, target only the weak, or abolish government.
- 30. (B)** The legislature makes laws (Latin *lex* 'law' + *latio* 'proposing'). Enforcing is the executive, interpreting is the judiciary, and commanding the army is not its defining role.
- 31. (C)** Legislature is from *lex/legis* ('law') + *latio* ('proposing'). 'To carry out' gives executive, 'judge' gives judiciary, and 'treaty' gives federalism.
- 32. (D)** Passing laws is the legislature's work. The executive enforces, the judiciary interprets, and the bureaucracy is the permanent executive.
- 33. (D)** The executive carries out and enforces laws (Latin *exsequi*, 'to carry out'). Making laws is the legislature and interpreting them the judiciary.
- 34. (C)** The executive's two parts are the political executive (ministers) and the permanent executive (bureaucracy). The other terms are invented.
- 35. (C)** The political executive - ministers - sets direction and changes with elections. Staying on regardless and exam-selection describe the permanent executive.
- 36. (B)** The permanent executive - civil servants - stays on and implements decisions across governments, giving stability. It does not change each election, make laws, or serve as head of state.

- 37. (A)** The day-to-day work is largely done by the permanent bureaucracy, not ministers alone. There is a bureaucracy, and the courts do not run daily administration.
- 38. (B)** The bureaucracy is the permanent, exam-selected civil service. Elected ministers are the political executive, judges the judiciary, and voters the electorate.
- 39. (D)** The judiciary interprets laws and settles disputes (Latin *judex*, 'judge'). Making laws is the legislature, enforcing the executive.
- 40. (C)** As an independent watchdog, the judiciary checks laws and actions against the Constitution. It does not obey the ruling party, make laws, or command the police.
- 41. (D)** Judicial review lets courts strike down laws and actions that breach the Constitution. It is not lawmaking, electing ministers, or tax collection.
- 42. (A)** Through judicial review the judiciary can strike down an unconstitutional law - a key check. It is not powerless, a lawmaker, or able to arrest voters.
- 43. (D)** An independent judiciary can check even the government fairly, upholding the Constitution. It is not party-controlled, minister-obeying, or check-removing.
- 44. (C)** The government's triple role is protector, provider and regulator. The others list organs, tiers, or parts of a state.
- 45. (D)** As protector the government keeps citizens safe and defends the country. Providing services is the provider role and setting rules the regulator role.
- 46. (B)** As provider the government supplies services such as schools, hospitals and roads. Defence is the protector role and rule-setting the regulator role.
- 47. (B)** As regulator (Latin *regula*, 'rule') the government sets and enforces fair rules. Fighting wars is protection and building hospitals is provision.
- 48. (A)** Setting and enforcing safety rules is the regulator role. Border defence is protection, road-building is provision, and voting is a citizen's act.
- 49. (A)** RTI lets citizens request information about government actions, increasing transparency and accountability. It is not double-voting, law-ignoring, or judge-appointing.
- 50. (B)** Citizens hold government accountable through grievance redressal, RTI, the media, civil society and voting. Ignoring elections, one-minister rule and abolishing the Constitution do the opposite.
- 51. (B)** Voting out a government is a key way citizens hold it accountable. It is not foreign sovereignty, the regulator role, or judicial review.

52. (B) A free media exposes failures and keeps the government accountable. It does not make laws, replace courts, or run the bureaucracy.

53. (D) Grievance redressal lets citizens raise and resolve complaints about services - a form of accountability. It is not foreign voting, appointing ministers, or striking down laws.

54. (C) The three tiers are union, state and local. The others list the organs, the triple role, or the parts of a state.

55. (D) Decentralisation spreads power so local matters are decided locally. It is not concentration, abolishing local bodies, or foreign control.

56. (A) Three tiers reflect decentralisation, with decisions at the appropriate level. It is not central concentration, one-person rule, or abolishing states.

57. (A) Federalism (Latin foedus, 'treaty') shares power between central and state/local governments. It is not all-central, no-centre, or king-rule.

58. (C) Letting a local body decide local roads is decentralisation. It is the opposite of centralising, abolishing the local tier, or foreign control.

59. (C) The state has four parts and endures; the government is one part that changes with elections. The other options reverse or conflate them.

60. (A) The government is one part of the state, the rule of law and rights shield minorities, and democracies like the UK are not republics - correcting all three errors. The other options keep one or more misconceptions.